infrastructure in the country coupled with creating awareness and financial literacy for *ensuring that the man on the street is not put to undue hardship*.'

The SBI Ecowrap report of April 2016, attached as Appendix 2, is the only document that has appeared in the public domain mentioning demonetization prior to the 8 November announcement. The report is prescient for the accuracy with which it described the logistical challenges that the country actually faced as a consequence of the note ban:

- Notes of denominations of ₹500 and ₹1,000 together accounted for approximately *85 per cent of the total value of banknotes in circulation* at end March 2015, while together they accounted for 22 per cent of the volume at end March 2015.
- Despite the presence of high denominations, RBI had spent ₹37.62 billion in printing notes in 2014–15. If the notes of these two denominations are withdrawn, *the cost of printing notes for RBI would also multiply*.
- *At the branch level*, the cost of handling cash would zoom and there would be *complete chaos* as the funds kept in these denominations will be flushed into the banking channels. Currently there are around *5,000 currency chests* across the country with the Banks that are used for storing notes. The capacity of these chests *would need to be expanded 5x* to enable storing of enough supply of currency to the public. Construction of these chests, which have specialized steel walls and doors, would take time and substantial investment.
- If the ₹500 and ₹1,000 denomination notes are removed, in order to maintain the same amount of liquidity, the number of other denomination notes will have to be increased… *A high transaction ATM which runs out of cash once a day will fall short of currency several times a day*. This is so because cash replenishment agencies will take a couple of hours to respond,